

Duck



Quack! Most of us would recognize the call of a mallard, the world's most common duck. However, not all ducks quack. Some species whistle, while others wail, squeak, coo, or even bark! Ducks live almost everywhere – the king eider even lives in the freezing Arctic. This tough duck dives into the chilly sea to hunt for clams. The male king eider is multicoloured, but like most types of duck the female is brown. The duller colours help her hide when she is nesting on the ground.

Though ducks walk with a clumsy waddle, they are champion fliers. Powerful wing muscles help them take off and speed up rapidly. The red-breasted merganser can fly at more than 160 kph (100 mph).